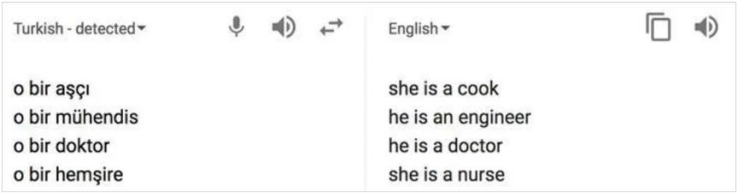
AP Computer Science Principles
Ticket Out the Door
Set 0: Understanding Data Literacy and Visualizations

Name _____ Period _____

Skill 0.1 Exercise 1
What is data literacy?
How can data help you solve problems?

Skill 0.2 Exercise 1
Give another example of "garbage in, garbage out" and explain what could go wrong because of it.

Skill 0.3 Exercise 1
Neural Machine Translation (NMT) is trained on example text that exists in the world. Consider the Google Translate that was constructed using NMT.  What is the bias in this translation.
How might Google Engineers modify the translation to remove bias?

AP Computer Science Principles
Ticket Out the Door
Set 0: Understanding Data Literacy and Visualizations

Name _____ Period _____

Skill 0.3 Exercise 2

In 2014, Amazon experimented with using software to screen job applicants. The screening software was trained on a decade of résumés that had been previously rated by employees as part of the hiring process. Below shows the distribution of male and female employees at Amazon in 2014.

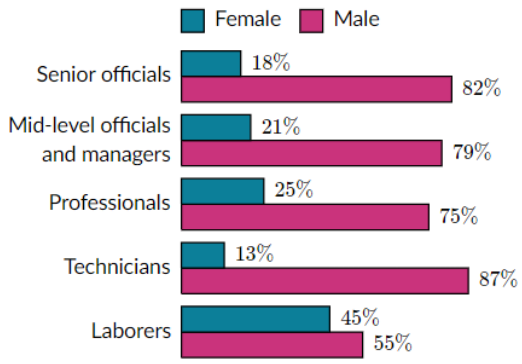


Chart source: Seattle Times

Is it statistically possible that the above results were by chance?

How might Amazon better train their software model to avoid "reckless regard" for the rights of female candidates?

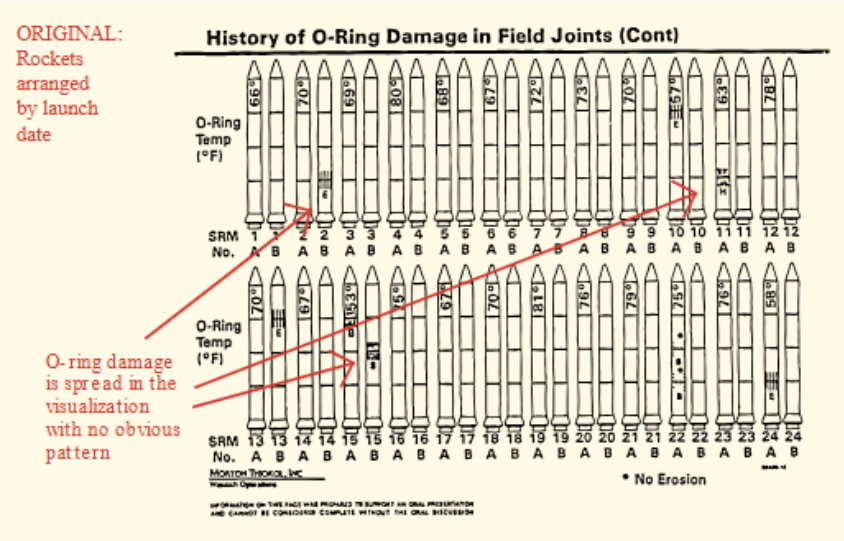
AP Computer Science Principles
Ticket Out the Door
Set 0: Understanding Data Literacy and Visualizations

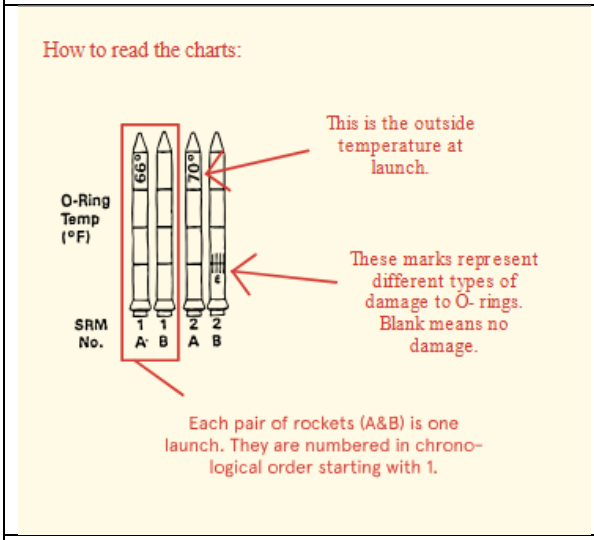
Name _____ Period _____

Skill 0.4 Exercise 1

On January 28, 1986 the Challenger space shuttle carried seven US astronauts who were supposed to deploy a satellite and study Halley's Comet while they were in orbit. Less than two minutes after takeoff, however, the shuttle exploded, killing all seven crew members. The explosion was caused by a failure of two O-rings: small rubber rings that helped create an airtight seal between the space shuttle and its launch fuel supply. Before the launch, engineers were concerned about how the low-temperature forecast would affect the O-rings' ability to make a proper seal. The engineers made their arguments in favor of postponing the launch using, in part, a series of data visualizations that showed launch success rates at various temperatures. Tragically, their arguments did not prevent the launch from proceeding.

Below are the visualizations.





What is the problem with the visualization?

How could the engineers have improved their visualization, and potentially prevented this tragedy?

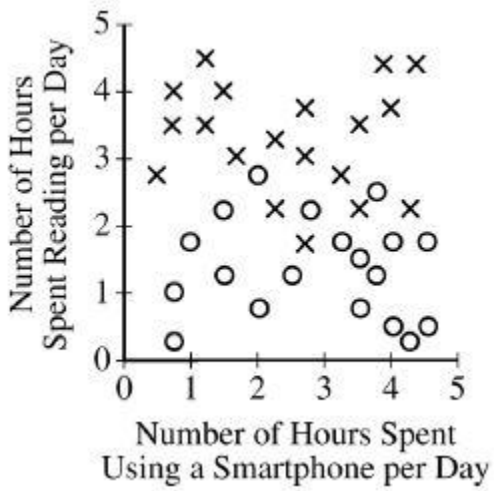
AP Computer Science Principles
Ticket Out the Door
Set 0: Understanding Data Literacy and Visualizations

Name _____ Period _____

Skill 0.5 Exercise 1

Participants in a survey were asked how many hours per day they spend reading, how many hours per day they spend using a smartphone, and whether or not they would be interested in a smartphone application that lets users share book reviews.

The data from the survey are represented in the graph below. Each × represents a survey participant who said he or she was interested in the application, and each ○ represents a participant who said he or she was not interested.



Which correlation is most consistent with the data in the graph?

A. Participants who read more were generally more likely to say they are interested in the application.

B. Participants who read more were generally less likely to say they are interested in the application.

C. Participants who use a smartphone more were generally more likely to say they read more.

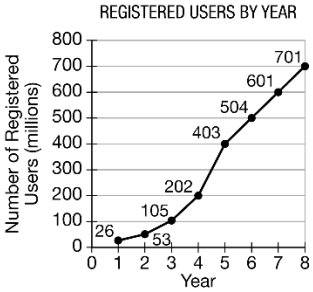
D. Participants who use a smartphone more were generally less likely to say they read more.

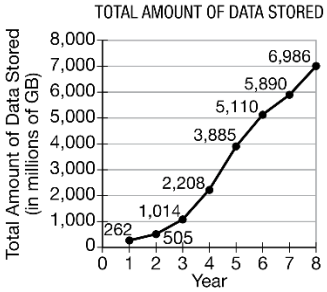
AP Computer Science Principles
Ticket Out the Door
Set 0: Understanding Data Literacy and Visualizations

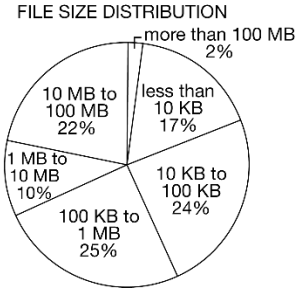
Name _____ Period _____

Skill 0.5 Exercise 2

A file storage application allows users to save their files on cloud servers. A group of researchers gathered user data for the first eight years of the application's existence. Some of the data are summarized in the following graphs. The line graph on the left shows the number of registered users each year. The line graph on the right shows the total amount of data stored by all users each year. The circle graph shows the distribution of file sizes currently stored by all users.







Which of the following correlations is most consistent with the information?

A. As the number of users increase, the size of the files stored increases

B. Over 75% of the files stored are 10 MB in size or less.

C. As the number of users increase, the amount of data stored per user increases

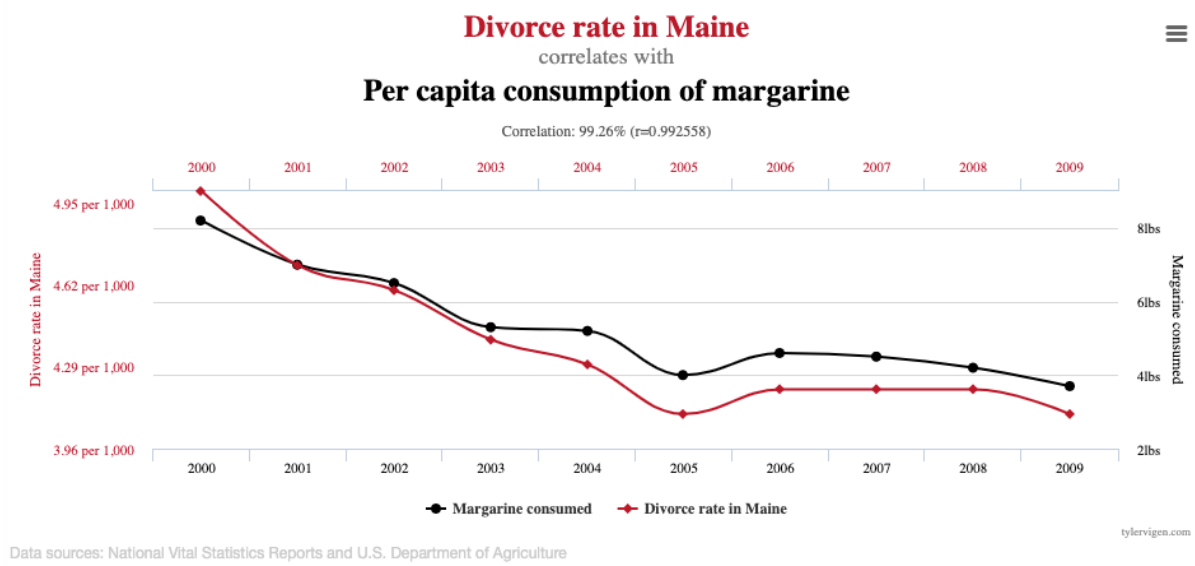
D. 75% of the files stored are at least 100 KB in size.

AP Computer Science Principles
Ticket Out the Door
Set 0: Understanding Data Literacy and Visualizations

Name _____ Period _____

Skill 0.6 Exercise 1

Refer to the graph below



What two variables are being compared in this graph?

Does the graph show correlation, causation, or both?

Why does this graph not prove that margarine consumption causes divorce in Maine?

What other explanations could account for the similar pattern in both lines?

AP Computer Science Principles
Ticket Out the Door
Set 0: Understanding Data Literacy and Visualizations

Name _____ Period _____

Skill 0.6 Exercise 2

Biologists often attach tracking collars to wild animals. For each animal, the following geolocation data is collected at frequent intervals.

- The time
- The date
- The location of the animal

Identify whether each statement is correlation or causation.

Statement	Correlation/Causation
Wolves travel up to 30 miles per day	
Wolves and deer travel together	
Wolves can run up to 40 miles per hour	
Wolves typically travel at dawn and dusk	
Wolves typically travel during cooler weather	

Skill 0.7 Exercise 1

A camera mounted on the dashboard of a car captures an image of the view from the driver's seat every second. Each image is stored as data. Along with each image, the camera also captures and stores the car's speed, the date and time, and the car's GPS location as metadata. Which of the following can best be determined using only the data and none of the metadata?

A. The average number of hours per day that the car is in use

B. The car's average speed on a particular day

C. The distance the car traveled on a particular day

D. The number of bicycles the car passed on a particular day

Skill 0.7 Exercise 2

A certain social media Web site allows users to post messages and to comment on other messages that have been posted. When a user posts a message, the message itself is considered data. In addition to the data, the site stores the following metadata.

- The time the message was posted
- The name of the user who posted the message
- The names of any users who comment on the message and the times the comments were made

For which of the following goals would it be more useful to analyze the data instead of the metadata?

A. To determine the users who post messages most frequently

B. To determine the time of day that the site is most active

C. To determine the topics that many users are posting about

D. To determine which posts from a particular user have received the greatest number of comments

AP Computer Science Principles
Ticket Out the Door
Set 0: Understanding Data Literacy and Visualizations

Name _____ Period _____

Skill 0.7 Exercise 3
A digital photo file contains data representing the level of red, green, and blue for each pixel in the photo. The file also contains metadata that describes the date and geographic location where the photo was taken. For which of the following goals would analyzing the metadata be more appropriate than analyzing the data?
A. Determining the likelihood that the photo is a picture of the sky **B.** Determining the likelihood that the photo was taken at a particular public event **C.** Determining the number of people that appear in the photo **D.** Determining the usability of the photo for projection onto a particular color background